

Northwind Analytics Pvt. Ltd.

Employee Handbook & HR Policy Manual

Effective Date: April 1, 2026 | Version 3.2

1. Leave Policy

All full-time employees are entitled to 24 days of paid earned leave per calendar year, credited at 2 days per month. In addition, employees receive 12 days of casual/sick leave per year and 10 public holidays as declared by HR each January.

1.1 Carry Forward and Encashment

A maximum of 15 unused earned leave days may be carried forward into the next calendar year; any balance beyond 15 days lapses on December 31. Employees may encash up to 10 accumulated earned leave days per year at their current basic salary rate, subject to manager and HR approval.

1.2 Maternity and Paternity Leave

Maternity leave is granted for 26 weeks for the first two children and 12 weeks for subsequent children, in line with the Maternity Benefit Act. Paternity leave of 15 calendar days is available to be availed within 6 months of the child's birth.

1.3 Notice Period for Planned Leave

Earned leave of 3 or more consecutive days requires at least 5 working days' advance notice to the reporting manager via the HR portal. Sick leave may be applied for retroactively within 2 working days of return.

2. Work-from-Home & Hybrid Policy

Employees in eligible roles may work remotely up to 2 days per week, subject to manager approval and team coverage requirements. Requests must be submitted through the HR portal at least 24 hours in advance. Fully remote arrangements require Director-level sign-off and are reviewed quarterly.

Employees working remotely are expected to be reachable during core hours (10:00 AM to 4:00 PM IST) and to maintain the same meeting and deliverable commitments as in-office staff.

3. Code of Conduct

Employees are expected to act with honesty, professionalism, and respect toward colleagues, clients, and partners at all times. The following are grounds for disciplinary action, up to and including termination:

- Harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind
- Misuse of company assets, data, or confidential information
- Conflicts of interest not disclosed to HR
- Falsification of records, timesheets, or expense claims

All employees must complete the annual Code of Conduct acknowledgment and POSH (Prevention of Sexual Harassment) training within 30 days of joining and annually thereafter.

4. Expense Reimbursement

Business-related travel, client entertainment, and work-from-home internet expenses are reimbursable with valid receipts submitted within 30 days of the expense date. Claims older than 60 days will not be processed without VP approval.

4.1 Travel Class Entitlement

Economy class air travel is standard for all domestic and international trips under 6 hours in duration. Business class is permitted for flights exceeding 6 hours for employees at the Director level and above.

4.2 Per Diem Rates

Domestic travel per diem is INR 1,800 per day for meals and incidentals. International travel per diem varies by destination and is published separately on the HR portal, ranging from USD 45 to USD 90 per day.

5. Performance Reviews & Promotions

Formal performance reviews are conducted twice yearly, in April and October. Reviews combine self-assessment, manager evaluation, and peer feedback. Promotion cycles align with the October review and require a minimum of 12 months in the current role, except in cases of exceptional performance approved by the department head.

6. Termination & Notice Period

The standard notice period is 60 days for employees and 90 days for employees at Manager level and above. The company may, at its discretion, pay in lieu of notice for part or all of this period. Employees terminated for cause under the Code of Conduct are not entitled to notice pay.

7. Health & Wellness Benefits

All full-time employees are covered under group medical insurance of INR 5 lakh per year, extendable to spouse, children, and dependent parents at a subsidized premium. Employees may also claim up to INR 15,000 annually toward gym memberships, fitness classes, or wellness apps under the Wellness Reimbursement Program.

This handbook is for illustrative and testing purposes and does not constitute an actual employment contract or legal document.